ad nauseam on each point. This has two benefits. It establishes a 'record' for the future, and it wears down the Indian interlocutor in order that she or he may bring up alternatives simply to break a 'deadlock' which the Chinese have deliberately created. Thus, it also serves the purpose of determining the opposite side's limits of flexibility or bottom line on an issue. While the repetition of positions by the Chinese interlocutor has to be accepted by the Indian side, when the Indian side resorts to this kind of tactic, the Chinese side will allege that the Indian negotiator is faithless, dogmatic or unreasonable.

A favourite allegation that is levelled by the Chinese side is that the Indian side is not 'meeting us halfway'. It is advisable for Indian interlocutors to follow the Chinese tactic of repeating the Indian position, both for the record and to test the Chinese negotiator's resolve and intentions. One tactic used by the Chinese side is to reverse a complaint. Thus, when the Indian interlocutor complains about Chinese action on the Line of Actual Control or certain Chinese actions in multilateral situations that are viewed negatively by India, the Chinese will make the same complaint against India. The purpose is to blur the distinctions and to thus neutralize Indian 'asks' without addressing the specific concern at all.

On issues that are particularly contentious or important, it is vital to be mindful of two sorts of Chinese plays. They will keep saying 'no' for as long as possible and, by doing so, keep all options on the table. These include options that do not exist, such as refusing to recognize Sikkim as a part of India when the rest of the world had already done so and China had no means of changing the ground realities. The purpose of saying 'no' to all the proposals made by the other side is to frustrate the Indian interlocutor to the point that she or he agrees to move on a step-by-step basis. This gives the Chinese greater opportunities to extract concessions at each step. An American